OurMocks

2027 CYCLE

MOCK · PRACTICE · CRACK

CUET UG

Business Studies

Consumer Protection

Official Syllabus Unit XII · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

INSIDE
Concept Notes

INSIDE
Solved Examples

INSIDE
Practice MCQs + Solutions

Aligned to the latest official syllabus · Concept-first explanations

www.ourmocks.com

Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Business Studies syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline, Unit XII)	Skills the questions test
Meaning and importance	Meaning and concept; Meaning, Importance of consumer protection.	Defining consumer protection as defence against unfair practices and stating why it matters — for consumers and for business.
Consumer Protection Act, 2019	The Consumer protection Act, 2019.	Recalling the three-tier machinery, the two money walls (₹50 lakh, ₹2 crore), the appeal ladder and the two-year complaint window.
Rights and responsibilities	Consumer rights; Consumer responsibilities.	Listing the six rights by name and matching responsibilities — quality marks, bills, genuine complaints — to described behaviour.
Who can file and remedies	Who can file a complaint?; Ways and means of consumer protection – Consumer awareness and legal redressal with special reference to Consumer protection Act 2019, Remedies available.	Naming who may file, and matching each remedy — replacement, refund, compensation, corrective advertisement — to a described case.
Consumer organisations and NGOs	Role of consumer organizations and NGOs.	Listing their activities — education, testing, filing complaints, legal aid — and separating them from the commissions' work.

OurMocks

EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each subject paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. Unit XII closes the syllabus

with list-and- machinery questions — rights, responsibilities, the three tiers, remedies and the role of NGOs carry nearly every item.

What Consumer Protection Actually Is

Every purchase is an act of trust — the buyer pays first and hopes. Because that trust can be betrayed by adulterated oil, false weight, hidden charges or an appliance that catches fire, societies build defences around the buyer. **Consumer protection** is the sum of those defences: laws, forums, awareness and organisations that keep sellers honest and give buyers a remedy when they are not.

- **Meaning:** consumer protection means **protecting consumers from unfair, restrictive and deceptive trade practices** — defective goods, poor services, false advertising and exploitation.
- **Who counts as a consumer:** any person who **buys goods or hires services** for consideration — for themselves or another person with their permission — but **not** for resale or commercial use.

Why consumer protection matters

- **Consumers are unorganised:** buyers act alone against organised sellers — protection balances the mismatch of power.
- **Consumers are often ignorant:** many do not know their rights, the marks that certify quality, or the forums that grant relief.
- **Exploitation is widespread:** adulteration, spurious goods, duplicate products, hoarding, black marketing, false weights, misleading advertising — the list writes itself in every market.
- **From the business's own point of view:** a firm that treats consumers well wins **long-term interest and repeat trust**; protection is also **ethical**, meets **government and legal expectations**, and answers **social responsibility**. Satisfied consumers are the cheapest marketing a firm can own.

The Consumer Protection Act, 2019

The Consumer Protection Act, 2019 **replaced** the 1986 Act — widening coverage to e-commerce, tightening the machinery, and adding a regulator (the Central Consumer Protection Authority) for unfair practices. Its heart for the exam is the **three-tier redressal machinery**.

- **District Commission:** hears claims **up to ₹50 lakh** — the entry door for most complaints; appeals go to the State Commission.
- **State Commission:** hears claims of **₹50 lakh to ₹2 crore**; appeals go to the National Commission.
- **National Commission:** hears claims **above ₹2 crore**; sits at New Delhi; appeals go to the Supreme Court.
- **The two money walls:** ₹50 lakh and ₹2 crore — revised in 2021 — decide the tier; the value of the claim picks the door.

- **The time window:** a complaint must be filed **within two years** of the cause of action.

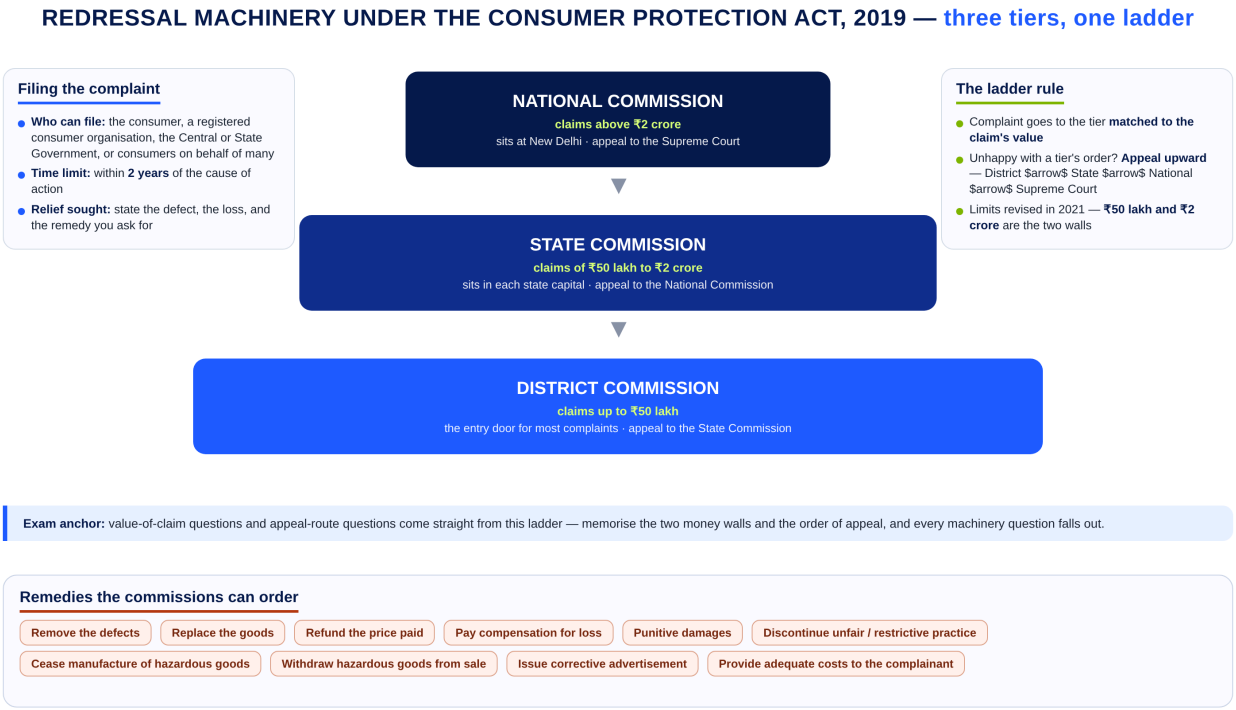


Figure 1: Figure 1 — The three-tier redressal machinery under the 2019 Act: which commission hears what, the appeal ladder, who can file, and the remedies the commissions can order.

Consumer Rights — The Six

- **Right to Safety:** protection against goods and services **hazardous to life and health** — the gas cylinder, the medicine, the toy must be safe.
- **Right to be Informed:** full information about **quality, quantity, purity, standard, price** — labels, marks and disclosures that leave no surprises.
- **Right to Choose:** access to a **variety of products** at fair prices — no forced buying through monopoly push.
- **Right to be Heard:** grievances **listened to at proper forums** — helplines, suggestion systems, and the commissions themselves.
- **Right to Seek Redressal: relief against unfair practices** — replacement, refund, compensation — through the legal machinery.
- **Right to Consumer Education:** the right to **learn one's rights and remedies** — through campaigns, courses and consumer literature.

Consumer Responsibilities — The Buyer's Half

Rights work only when buyers also behave as responsible partners in the market. The syllabus lists the responsible habits; each one prevents an exploitation that the law would otherwise have to fix later.

- **Check quality marks:** buy certified goods — **ISI** for electricals, **Agmark** for agricultural produce, **Hallmark** for gold.

- **Ask for a cash memo or bill:** the bill is the **proof of purchase** — without it, redressal collapses.
- **Read labels honestly:** check contents, expiry, weight and price before paying.
- **Buy only what is needed:** resist persuasion that manufactures wants — the consumer's own restraint is a protection.
- **Be ecologically responsible:** dispose of waste properly, prefer recyclable packaging, return what can return.
- **Form consumer societies:** collective voices carry further — societies and associations multiply each buyer's strength.
- **Complain genuinely:** use the forums for real grievances — frivolous complaints waste the machinery that genuine ones need.

Who Can File a Complaint — and What Relief Follows

- **The consumer** who bought the goods or hired the services — or **any consumer on behalf of many consumers** with their consent.
- **A registered consumer organisation or association** — acting for any consumer.
- **The Central or State Government** — as protector of public interest.
- **A legal heir or representative** of a consumer who cannot act.

The remedies available

- **Remove the defects** in the goods or correct the deficiencies in the service.
- **Replace** the defective product with a new one.
- **Refund** the price paid.
- **Pay compensation** for the loss or injury suffered — and **punitive damages** where the conduct deserves punishment.
- **Discontinue** the unfair or restrictive practice.
- **Cease manufacture** of hazardous goods and **withdraw** hazardous goods from sale.
- **Issue a corrective advertisement** to undo the effect of a false claim.
- **Provide adequate costs** to the complainant.

Ways and Means of Consumer Protection

- **Self-regulation by business:** ethical firms adopt their own standards — the cheapest protection is a seller who needs none.
- **Business associations:** chambers and associations frame codes of conduct their members must follow.
- **Consumer awareness:** informed buyers who check marks, bills and labels — the first line of defence.
- **Consumer organisations and NGOs:** the collective watchdog (see below).
- **Government and legal redressal:** the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 and its three-tier commissions — the last and strongest line.

Role of consumer organisations and NGOs

- **Educating consumers:** publishing journals, guides and rankings that sharpen buying judgment.
- **Testing products:** independently checking samples in labs and publishing the results — pressure that keeps quality honest.
- **Filing complaints and PILs:** carrying cases for consumers who cannot pursue them alone.
- **Providing legal aid:** advice, documentation and representation.
- **Running awareness campaigns:** rights, marks, forums — taught before the fraud happens, not after.

EVERYDAY EXAMPLE — THE FAMILY CHECK-LIST

Before the festival shopping run, a careful family **checks marks** (ISI on the lights, Agmark on the sweets), **bills everything**, **reads expiry labels**, and **files a complaint** when the faulty heater won't be exchanged. Each habit is one of the responsibilities — and the complaint is the machinery behind them. Consumer protection is this check-list turned into law.

Key Facts & Terms Cheatsheet

KEY FACTS & TERMS CHEATSHEET — UNIT XII (CONSUMER PROTECTION)

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Consumer protection	Defence against unfair, deceptive trade practices	Laws + forums + awareness + NGOs
Why needed	Unorganised, ignorant consumers; widespread exploitation	Adulteration, spurious goods, hoarding
Importance to business	Long-term interest, ethics, government pressure, social responsibility	Satisfied consumers return
CPA 2019	Replaced the 1986 Act; covers e-commerce; added CCPA	Current redressal law
District Commission	Claims up to ₹50 lakh — the entry tier	Appeal to State
State Commission	Claims ₹50 lakh to ₹2 crore	Appeal to National
National Commission	Claims above ₹2 crore — sits at New Delhi	Appeal to Supreme Court

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Complaint window	File within 2 years of the cause of action	Not 1 year, not 3
Right to Safety	Protection from hazardous goods and services	Gas cylinder, medicines, toys
Right to be Informed	Quality, quantity, purity, standard, price disclosed	Labels, marks, disclosures
Right to Choose / be Heard	Variety at fair prices; grievances heard	Forums, helplines
Right to Redressal / Education	Relief against unfair practices; learn rights	Replacement, refund, compensation
Responsibilities	Check ISI/Agmark/Hallmark, take bills, read labels, genuine complaints, societies	Bill = proof of purchase
Who can file	Consumer, consumer organisation, Government, representative of many, legal heir	Five doors
Remedies	Remove defects, replace, refund, compensate, punitive damages, stop practice, withdraw hazardous goods, corrective ad	Ten options total
NGO roles	Educate, publish, test samples, file complaints, legal aid, campaigns	Watchdogs outside the law

Carry everywhere: the two money walls — **₹50 lakh and ₹2 crore**; the appeal ladder — **District → State → National → Supreme Court**; the complaint window — **2 years**; rights are six.

Common Errors and Special Cases

COMMON ERRORS & SPECIAL CASES

The mistake students make	What is right	The why / the trap
"Asking for a bill is a consumer right"	Taking the bill is a **responsibility**; the **right to be heard** is the forum's duty	Rights are what the system owes you; responsi-

The mistake students make	What is right	The why / the trap
		bilities are what you owe the system.
"The 1986 Act still governs redressal"	The **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** replaced it — and covers e-commerce	Every machinery question answers under the 2019 Act now.
"Any claim goes to any commission"	The **value of the claim** picks the tier — up to ₹50 lakh District; to ₹2 crore State; above that National	The two walls decide; memorise them in order.
"A person reselling goods is a consumer"	A consumer buys for **own use** — resale or commercial use disqualifies	The shopkeeper buying stock is not a consumer under the Act.
"Complaints can be filed any time"	The window is **2 years** from the cause of action	Time-barred complaints fail before the merits are even heard.
"Consumer organisations decide the cases"	Organisations **file and support** complaints; only the **commissions** decide	Watchdogs advise and advocate — the benches award relief.

- **Spot the pattern:** this unit's traps are **list swaps** — rights vs responsibilities, who files vs who decides, the tiers' money walls. Learn each list as a set and test yourself by shuffled items.
- **One special case:** "a shopkeeper buys stock for resale and sues for defects" — he is **not a consumer** under the Act; the redressal machinery does not open for resale purchases.

The Whole Chapter on One Page

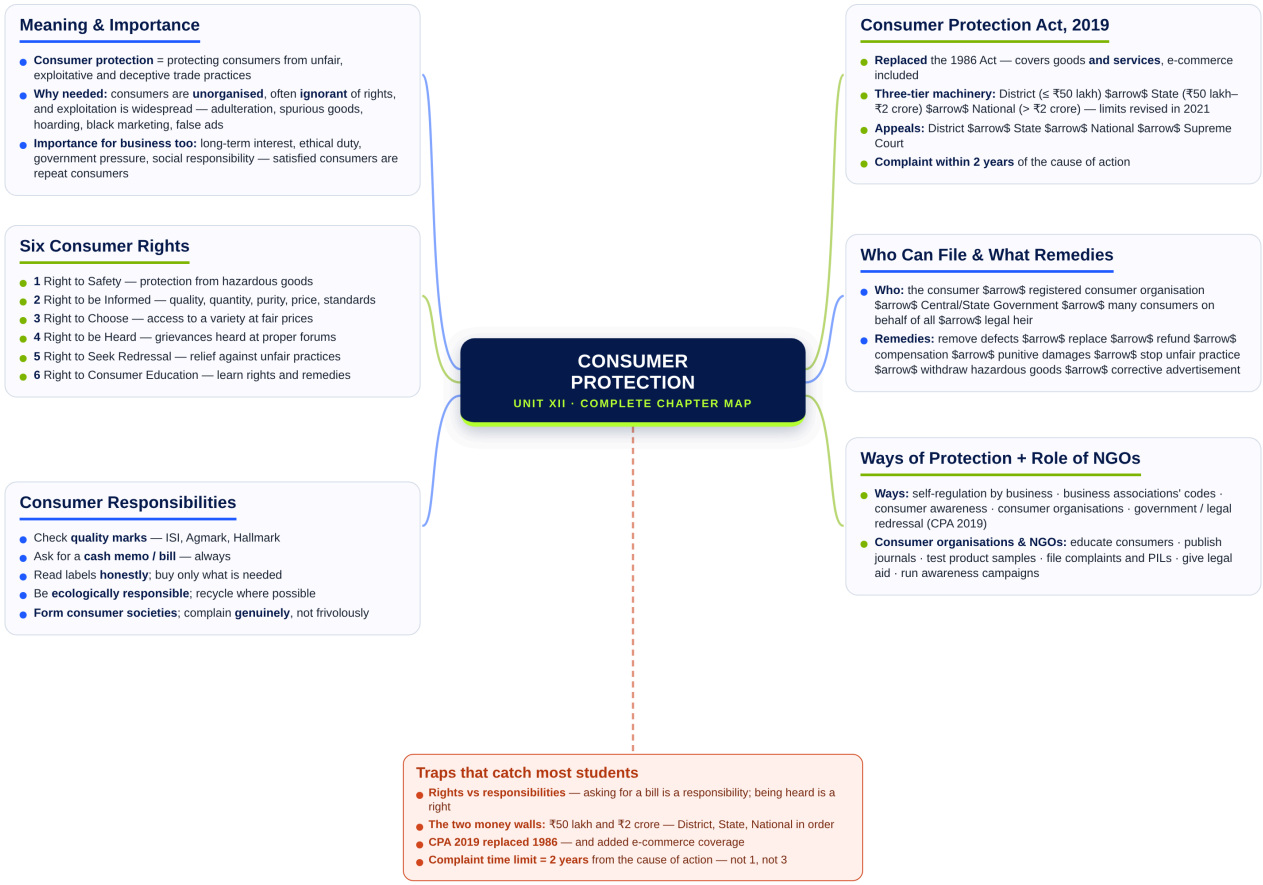


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Whole chapter on one page: meaning and importance, the 2019 Act's machinery, the six rights, the responsibilities, who files and what remedies follow, the ways of protection with NGOs, and the four traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions

Q1. Consumer protection means:

(A) protecting sellers from competition

(B) protecting consumers against unfair, restrictive and deceptive trade practices

(C) protecting the government's tax revenue

(D) protecting advertisers from criticism

Q2. A person who buys goods **for resale** in his shop wants to file a complaint for defects. Under the Act he is:

(A) a consumer entitled to file

(B) not a consumer — goods bought for commercial resale fall outside the definition

(C) a consumer only for services

(D) entitled to file only through an NGO

Q3. A consumer's claim is worth ₹1.2 crore. The commission competent to hear it first is the:

(A) District Commission
(B) State Commission
(C) National Commission
(D) Supreme Court

Q4. The correct appeal ladder under the 2019 Act runs:

(A) District → National → State
(B) State → District → National
(C) District → State → National → Supreme Court
(D) National → State → District

Q5. A defective pressure cooker risks bursting. The consumer right most directly involved is the right to:

(A) safety
(B) choose
(C) be heard
(D) consumer education

Q6. Which of the following is a consumer **responsibility**, not a right?

(A) right to be informed about purity and price
(B) asking for a cash memo at the time of purchase
(C) right to seek redressal
(D) right to consumer education

Q7. A complaint about a service whose failure occurred on 10 March must be filed by 10 March of which later year?

(A) the same year
(B) one year later
(C) two years later
(D) three years later

Q8. The commission orders a company to publish a corrected advertisement after a false claim. The remedy used is:

(A) refund of price
(B) replacement of goods
(C) corrective advertisement
(D) punitive damages

Q9. A registered consumer society files a complaint on behalf of an aggrieved villager. Under the Act, this is:

(A) not permitted — only the consumer may file
(B) permitted — registered consumer organisations can file complaints
(C) permitted only with the Government's approval
(D) permitted only for claims above ₹2 crore

OurMocks

Q10. An NGO gets shampoo samples tested in its own lab and publishes the results. Its role here is:

(A) deciding the case as a commission

(B) testing products and publishing results — a watchdog activity of consumer organisations

(C) regulating prices

(D) issuing quality marks like ISI

Solutions

Sol. Q1. Consumer protection is the shield for the **buyer**: laws, forums, awareness and organisations guarding against unfair, restrictive and deceptive trade practices. It protects consumers — not sellers, tax or advertisers.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. The Act defines a consumer as one buying for **own use or use by a permitted person** — **not for resale or commercial purpose**. A shopkeeper buying stock for resale falls outside the definition.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q3. ₹1.2 crore sits between the two money walls — above ₹50 lakh and up to ₹2 crore — so the **State Commission** hears it first. The District ceiling is ₹50 lakh; the National floor is ₹2 crore.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q4. Appeals climb one tier at a time: **District → State → National**, and from the National Commission to the **Supreme Court**. Every other order skips or inverts a tier.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q5. Protection from goods **hazardous to life and health** is the **right to safety** — the first of the six rights. Being heard and education are separate rights.

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q6. Asking for and keeping the **cash memo** is a **responsibility** — the buyer's own habit that makes redressal possible. The other three options are rights the system owes.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q7. The complaint window is **two years** from the date the cause of action arose — here, 10 March, two years later. One year and three years are distractors.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q8. When a false claim must be undone publicly, the commission can order a **corrective advertisement** — one of the ten remedies, aimed at reversing the deception.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q9. A **registered consumer organisation** may file a complaint on behalf of any consumer — one of the five doors into the machinery. No government approval or value limit is needed.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q10. Independent testing and publishing of results is a classic **watchdog activity** of consumer organisations. Only the commissions decide cases; ISI marks are issued by the BIS, not NGOs.

Answer: (B)

© OurMocks · www.ourmocks.com · CUET UG Business Studies · Consumer Protection · 2027 cycle

OurMocks